



First Numbers

A small journey through two, five, and eight

2 5 8

SEE - MAKE - WRITE - SHOW

Child's initials

Date started

This is an early pilot, made to be used rather than admired. Please let the child respond in their own way. There is nothing to prepare and nothing to perform.

A quiet test, not a lesson to perfect

Two short sittings are enough

1

CHOOSE A CALM MOMENT

Try Meet Two and Meet Five in the first sitting. Save Meet Eight for another day if the child is still interested.

2

READ EACH PAGE ALOUD

Read the title and short directions whether or not the child reads. You may point to the words. The child never needs to read alone.

3

GROWN-UP BOXES ARE FOR YOU

Use their guidance quietly. Say words in quotation marks to the child, then give them time to respond in their own way.

4

WAIT, THEN STOP KINDLY

Do not supply the answer. The child may stop at any time; a skipped or unfinished page is useful feedback.

WHAT TO HAVE NEARBY

A pencil or crayon and eight small objects: pebbles, buttons, beans, blocks, or anything safe to move.

Please keep the child's pages. Your private feedback link comes with the download.

SEE IT



One or two?

Small quantities can be noticed without counting.

ONE



TWO



Point to two. Now point to one.

GROWN-UP PROMPT

Ask: "Which group has two? How did you know?"

Notice: whether two is recognized without counting

MAKE IT



Make a pair

Two things can belong together.

Place two small things together inside the clearing.

MAKE A PAIR HERE

Now move one object into each home.

ONE HERE

ONE HERE

GROWN-UP PROMPT

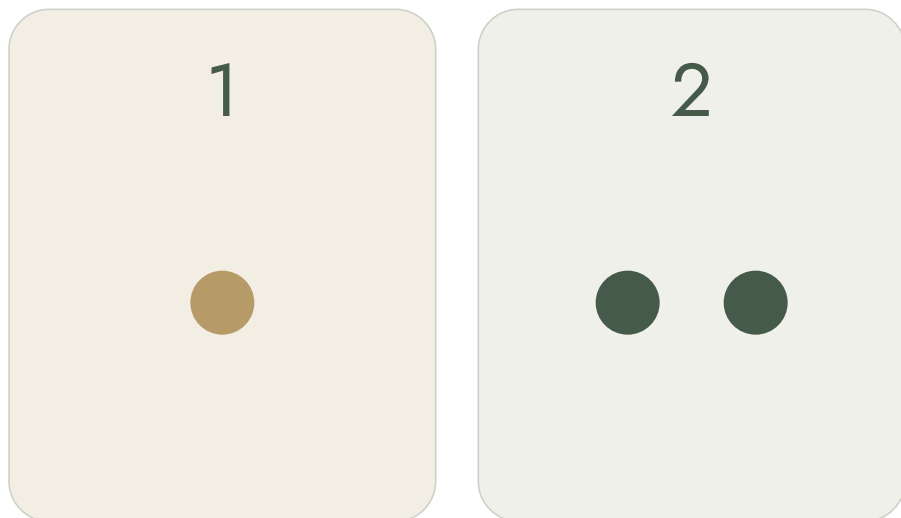
Ask: "Are there still two altogether?"

Notice: whether separating the pair changes the answer



Which has more?

Compare one with two.



Point to the group with more.

What could make both groups the same?

GROWN-UP PROMPT

Ask: "Which has more? What could you change to make them the same?"

Notice: whether comparison uses quantity rather than size



Meet the numeral 2

Write two, then show two another way.



Follow the pale 2 slowly with your finger.

TRACE ONE



COPY ONE



TRY ONE



SHOW TWO ANOTHER WAY



GROWN-UP PROMPT

Do not correct the writing. Ask the child to explain the final marks.

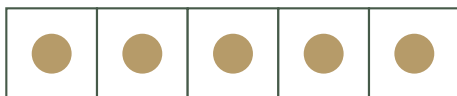
Notice: whether support fades and two can be represented independently

SEE IT

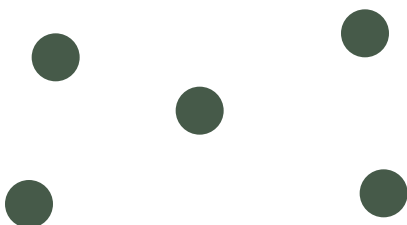


How many did you see?

Look first. Count only if you need to.



Look for two seconds. Then the grown-up hides the frame.



Now look at five in a new arrangement.

GROWN-UP PROMPT

Show for two seconds, cover with your hand, then ask: "How many?"

Notice: whether the child recognizes five or counts each object

MAKE IT



Gather and make five

A number tells us how many.

Find five small things. Place them inside the clearing below.

MAKE FIVE HERE

5

Touch each object once as you count.

GROWN-UP PROMPT

When the child stops, ask: "How many are there?"

Notice: whether the final number answers how many



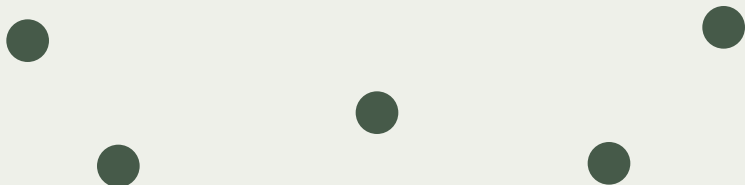
Five stays five

Things can move without changing how many.

1. PUT FIVE CLOSE TOGETHER



2. SPREAD THE SAME FIVE FAR APART



Did the number change?

GROWN-UP PROMPT

Ask: "Are there still five? How do you know?"

Notice: whether wider spacing changes the child's answer



Meet the numeral 5

A written 5 is another way to show five.



Follow the pale 5 slowly with your finger.

TRACE ONE



COPY ONE



TRY ONE



GROWN-UP PROMPT

Let the child choose pencil or crayon. Do not correct the result.

Notice: whether the support can fade from trace to independent attempt



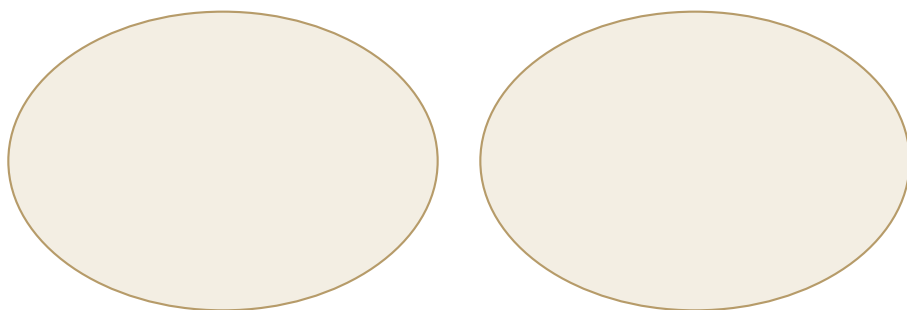
Ways to make five

Five can be made from two smaller parts.

Share five objects between the two nests.

FIRST PART

SECOND PART



Move one object. What changes?

Try another way if the child wants to continue.

GROWN-UP PROMPT

Ask: "Are there still five? How do you know?"

Notice: whether the child knows the total without counting everything again



Show five your way

There is more than one good way to show a number.

Make, draw, mark, or write something that shows five.

YOUR WAY

5

CHILD'S WORDS: _____

DATE: _____ AGE: _____

Keep this page only if it feels meaningful to you.

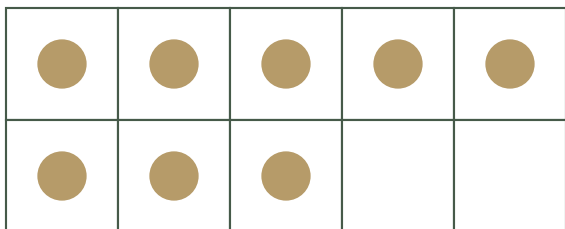
SEE IT



Five and three more

A full row is five. Three more make eight.

FIVE



5 and 3 more make 8

The empty spaces show how close eight is to ten.

GROWN-UP PROMPT

Ask: "Where do you see five? Where do you see three more?"

Notice: whether eight is seen as five and three, not only recounted

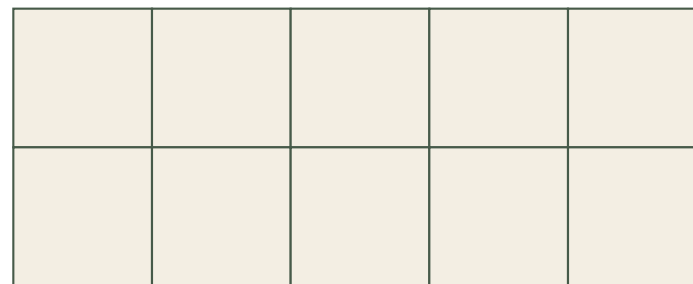
MAKE IT



Build eight

Fill five first. Then add three more.

Use eight small objects. Place one object in each space.



First make five across the top row.

Then place three more below.

GROWN-UP PROMPT

When the frame is filled, ask: "How many altogether?"

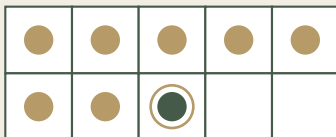
Notice: whether the child uses the five structure or restarts at one



One more, one less

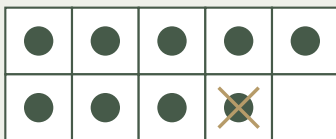
Seven, eight, and nine are neighbours.

SEVEN. ADD ONE MORE.



the outlined circle is one more

NINE. TAKE ONE AWAY.



the crossed circle is taken away

Both now show eight.

GROWN-UP PROMPT

Ask: "What changed in each frame? How many now?"

Notice: whether the child relates neighbouring quantities

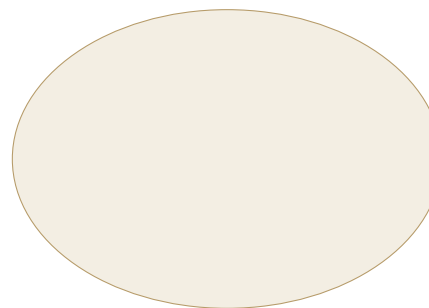


Ways to make eight

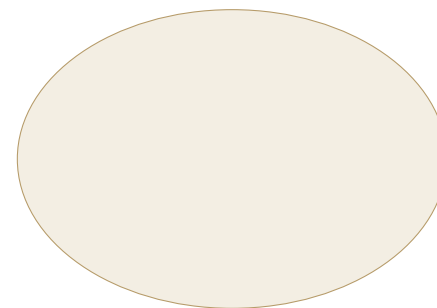
Eight can be split into two parts.

Share eight objects between the two nests.

FIRST PART



SECOND PART



Can both nests have the same number?

Move one object. Are there still eight?

GROWN-UP PROMPT

Ask: "How many are in each nest?"

Notice: whether the child finds four and four and keeps the whole eight



Meet the numeral 8

A written 8 is another way to show eight.



Follow the pale 8 slowly with your finger.

TRACE ONE



COPY ONE

8

TRY ONE

GROWN-UP PROMPT

Let the child choose pencil or crayon. Do not correct the result.

Notice: whether support fades from trace to independent attempt



Show eight your way

Make, draw, mark, or write something that shows eight.

YOUR WAY



CHILD'S WORDS: _____

DATE: _____

AGE: _____

Keep this page only if it feels meaningful to you.

What happened matters more than a score

Thank you for lending us your eyes

AFTER TWO SHORT SESSIONS

- Keep the completed or unfinished pages.
- Use the private feedback link sent with this pilot.
- Tell us where you explained, waited, stopped, or saw delight.
- Please report what happened, even when a page did not work.

No child photographs or videos are needed.

A grown-up's careful observations are enough.



You are helping us make fewer, better pages.

When usable feedback is complete, founding families will receive the finished First Numbers book free when it is released, or equivalent product credit if the direction changes.